

CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-06-01

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

18

Market Items

15

Thought

12

Competitors

5

Regulatory

49

Urgent

1

Watch

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

RBI Cash M
attention. The

Contents

Section	Items
Market Intelligence	18
Thought Leadership	15
Competitor Monitor	12
Regulatory Radar	5
Flagship Reports	4

URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-05-28 | #01

EU Instant Payments Mandate: CEE Banks Face Implementation Hurdles

The European Union's Instant Payments Regulation mandates that all euro credit transfers be processed instantly, 24/7/365, with no additional fees compared to standard SEPA credit transfers. The first key deadline for receiving instant payments is January 2025, with sending capabilities required by January 2026 for Eurozone countries, and later for non-Eurozone members. CEE banks, many operating in non-Eurozone countries but handling EUR payments, face complex technical upgrades to their core banking systems and liquidity management frameworks. The regulation also includes a Verification of Payee (VoP) requirement to combat fraud, which banks must integrate into their instant payment offerings. This shift necessitates significant investment in infrastructure and operational adjustments for both financial institutions and their corporate clients.

- Mandatory instant processing for EUR credit transfers.
- 24/7/365 availability and no extra fees.
- VoP requirement to enhance fraud prevention.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for RBI CMiplus as it directly impacts payment processing in all CEE markets. CMiplus must ensure full compliance with instant payment capabilities, VoP integration, and competitive fee structures across its network banks, supporting both Eurozone and non-Eurozone CEE countries.

URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-05-15 | #02

PSD3 Proposals Target Enhanced Open Banking, Fraud Prevention

The new legislative package, comprising PSD3 and the PSR, seeks to replace PSD2 with updated rules addressing gaps and new challenges in the digital payment ecosystem. Key proposals include making open banking data sharing more robust and secure, enhancing user control over their financial data, and mandating stronger fraud prevention tools, particularly for instant payments and spoofing scams. For corporates, this means potential for more sophisticated API-driven treasury solutions, but also increased compliance burdens related to security and data protection. The regulation is expected to streamline payment operations while placing greater responsibility on banks and payment service providers to protect users from financial crime.

- PSD3/PSR to replace PSD2, enhancing open banking.
- Focus on stronger fraud prevention, especially for instant payments.
- Improved consumer data control and security.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 and PSR are highly relevant for CMiplus as they will shape future API offerings, fraud prevention strategies, and overall compliance requirements for payment services in CEE. RBI must proactively adapt its platform and services to meet new regulatory standards and leverage enhanced open banking capabilities.

AI Revolutionizes Payment Fraud Detection for Corporates

The rapid adoption of instant payments has brought increased efficiency but also new challenges in fraud prevention, as fraudulent transactions must be identified and blocked within seconds. AI and ML algorithms are proving instrumental in this fight, capable of analyzing vast datasets of transaction patterns, user behavior, and network anomalies in real-time. These systems can detect deviations that human analysts or rule-based systems might miss, such as unusual payment amounts, recipient changes, or atypical geographic locations. Corporates are integrating AI-powered tools into their treasury systems to protect against Business Email Compromise (BEC), invoice fraud, and account takeover attempts, working closely with their banking partners to leverage these advanced capabilities.

- AI/ML crucial for real-time fraud detection in instant payments.
- Analyzes transaction patterns, user behavior, and network anomalies.
- Detects sophisticated fraud like BEC and account takeovers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Integrating advanced AI-driven fraud prevention capabilities is paramount for CMIplus to protect its corporate clients, especially with the increasing volume of instant payments. RBI should explore partnerships and internal development to offer state-of-the-art fraud detection and prevention tools within the CMIplus platform.

PSD3: EU Commission Proposes New Payment Services Directive

The proposed PSD3 aims to modernize the regulatory framework for payment services across the EU, building on the successes and lessons learned from PSD2. A significant focus is placed on combating payment fraud through enhanced data sharing and stronger authentication protocols. The directive also seeks to further unlock the potential of Open Banking by clarifying API access rules and encouraging greater competition among payment service providers. This evolution is expected to drive the development of new payment solutions and improve the overall customer experience. The legislative process will now involve the European Parliament and Council for adoption, with potential implementation timelines to be determined.

- Proposal for PSD3 unveiled by European Commission.
- Focus on enhanced payment security and fraud prevention.
- Aims to further promote Open Banking and innovation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3's emphasis on enhanced security and Open Banking directly impacts CMIplus. RBI Cash Management will need to ensure its platform and services align with new fraud prevention requirements and leverage Open Banking APIs to offer innovative solutions to CEE clients. This directive will shape the future of payment processing and digital banking services within the RBI network.

ISO 2022 Adoption Accelerates Across European Corporates

Corporates are increasingly recognizing the benefits of ISO 2022, which offers a standardized, structured, and data-rich format for financial transactions. This move facilitates better straight-through processing, improved reconciliation, and more sophisticated cash flow forecasting. The standard is becoming a de facto global language for payments, and its adoption is crucial for seamless cross-border transactions and integration with treasury management systems (TMS) and enterprise resource planning (ERP) systems. Banks and corporates are investing in upgrading their systems to support the new standard, with many aiming for full compliance within the next 18-24 months.

- ISO 2022 adoption is accelerating in Europe.
- Benefits include richer data, better interoperability, and reporting.
- Crucial for seamless cross-border transactions and system integration.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The accelerated adoption of ISO 2022 is a critical development for CMIplus. RBI Cash Management must ensure robust support for ISO 2022 across all its channels, including EBICS and H2H, to meet client demands for richer data and improved processing. This standard is fundamental to modernizing payment factories and treasury operations within the CEE region.

Instant Payments Gaining Traction: Real-Time Transactions Surge

Instant payment schemes, enabling real-time credit transfers 24/7/365, are becoming increasingly popular. This shift is fueled by the convenience and speed they offer, particularly for e-commerce, peer-to-peer transfers, and urgent business payments. For corporates, instant payments offer enhanced liquidity management capabilities, allowing for more dynamic cash positioning and faster settlement of obligations. Banks are investing in infrastructure to support higher volumes and ensure the security and reliability of these real-time services. The continued expansion of instant payment networks across CEE countries presents significant opportunities for CMIplus to offer value-added services.

- Instant payment transaction volumes are surging across Europe.
- Driven by demand for immediate funds availability and convenience.
- Offers enhanced liquidity management and faster settlement for corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The surge in instant payments is highly relevant to CMIplus and RBI Cash Management. We need to ensure our platform is fully equipped to handle instant payment initiation and reporting for our CEE clients, enabling them to leverage real-time capabilities for improved liquidity and operational efficiency. This aligns with our strategy to offer cutting-edge payment solutions.

PSD3 Consultation: Focus on Open Banking, Payments, and Consumer Protection

The European Commission has initiated a public consultation period for the upcoming Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3). This consultation seeks feedback on how to further develop the regulatory framework for payment services across the EU. Key themes under consideration include the evolution of Open Banking, the need for enhanced security measures in payment transactions, and the strengthening of consumer protection rights. The initiative aims to foster innovation while ensuring a safe and efficient payments landscape. Feedback from stakeholders will be crucial in shaping the final legislative proposals.

- European Commission launched PSD3 consultation.
- Focus on Open Banking evolution.
- Enhancing payment security is a priority.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 will significantly impact how CMIplus interacts with third-party providers and how customer data is managed. The focus on enhanced security and consumer rights will require ongoing adaptation of our API strategies and data handling protocols.

ISO 20022 Adoption Accelerates for Cross-Border Payments

The transition to ISO 20022 for payment messaging is experiencing a significant acceleration, with a particular emphasis on cross-border and high-value payment systems. The standard's ability to carry richer, structured data beyond traditional formats is seen as a key enabler for improved straight-through processing, enhanced fraud detection, and greater transparency in financial transactions. As more central banks and payment infrastructures mandate or strongly encourage ISO 20022 adoption, corporates are urged to align their treasury systems and payment factories to leverage these benefits.

- ISO 20022 adoption is accelerating globally.
- Cross-border payments are a key focus area.
- Richer data capabilities improve efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus's commitment to ISO 20022 is crucial for supporting our clients' evolving needs in cross-border payments. Ensuring seamless integration and data enrichment capabilities will be a priority to maintain our competitive edge in the CEE region.

Digital Euro Pilot Progresses, Scheme Rulebook Nears Completion

The European Central Bank is actively engaged in the exploratory and pilot phases of the Digital Euro, aiming to define its role as a public digital currency. Work focuses on ensuring privacy, establishing robust technical infrastructure, and developing a comprehensive scheme rulebook to govern its use. This initiative is crucial for maintaining monetary sovereignty and fostering innovation in digital payments within the Euro area, addressing concerns around cross-border payments and financial inclusion. The project involves extensive stakeholder engagement and research into its potential impact on the financial system and future payment rails.

- Ongoing pilot and exploratory work for Digital Euro.
- Focus on privacy and robust technical specifications.
- Comprehensive scheme rulebook under active development.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The Digital Euro represents a significant future shift in payment infrastructure. CMIplus must monitor its development closely to understand potential integration requirements, new payment rails, and implications for corporate liquidity management, especially for multi-currency operations and cross-border payments in CEE.

Bulgaria Set to Join Euro Area in 2026

The ECB's information confirms Bulgaria's planned accession to the Euro area in 2026. This event will necessitate a complete overhaul of financial systems and payment infrastructures in Bulgaria to align with Eurosystem standards. For businesses operating in CEE, this means a simplification of cross-border transactions with Bulgaria, reduced FX risks, and potential for more streamlined cash management. Banks like RBI will need to prepare their systems for the conversion, including updates to multi-currency accounts, payment processing, and reporting for their corporate clients. This accession underscores the ongoing economic integration within the European Union.

- Bulgaria's planned Euro area entry in 2026.
- Impacts banking operations and payment systems in CEE.
- Simplifies cross-border transactions and reduces FX risks.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for CMIplus, especially for clients with operations in Bulgaria or across CEE. RBI must ensure its systems are ready for the currency conversion, including ISO 20022 messaging, SEPA compliance, and multi-currency cash pooling capabilities, to support seamless transitions for corporate clients.

ECB Reinforces Instant Payments and SEPA Adoption

The ECB's strategic focus on 'Instant payments' and 'SEPA' under its retail payments strategy highlights the continuous effort to modernize European payment infrastructure. This includes promoting the full implementation of the EU Instant Payments Regulation, which mandates payment service providers to offer instant credit transfers in euro. The regulation sets deadlines for both receiving (Q1 2025 for euro area PSPs) and sending (Q1 2027 for euro area PSPs) instant payments, ensuring widespread availability. The ECB also oversees SEPA compliance, ensuring harmonized payment processing across the Euro area. These initiatives are critical for fostering innovation, improving liquidity management for corporates, and reducing payment fraud risks.

- Ongoing push for instant payment adoption across Europe.
- Reinforcement of SEPA standards and compliance.
- EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates instant credit transfers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance with the Instant Payments Regulation and SEPA standards across all CEE network banks. This impacts real-time payment processing, liquidity management services, and potentially new API offerings for corporate clients seeking immediate payment capabilities and enhanced treasury operations.

PingPong and Visa Innovate B2B Card-to-Account Payments

The newly launched solution by PingPong and Visa addresses a significant challenge in B2B payments: the inability to use commercial cards for suppliers who lack card acceptance infrastructure. By enabling card-to-account payments, the solution streamlines the payment process for corporate buyers, offering flexibility and potentially extending payment terms benefits. This development aims to modernise B2B transactions, reduce manual reconciliation efforts, and improve working capital management for businesses. It leverages existing card networks to facilitate direct bank account transfers, bridging the gap between card-based payments and traditional account-to-account transfers, thereby enhancing efficiency in corporate payment flows.

- PingPong and Visa partnership launched a new B2B payment solution.
- The solution enables card-to-account payments for corporate buyers.
- Allows payment to suppliers who do not accept commercial cards directly.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This solution is highly relevant for CMIplus as it offers a new, efficient method for corporate clients to manage B2B payments, potentially reducing friction and improving cash flow. RBI Cash Management should monitor its adoption and consider how such hybrid payment rails could be integrated or offered to CEE corporates, especially for cross-border B2B flows and payment factory optimisation.

Europe's Future: A2A Payments, Wallets, and Digital Identity

At the Money Motion 2026 conference, Marina Repo provided insights into the evolving European payments landscape. Her discussion highlighted the growing importance of mobile wallets as a primary interface for consumers and businesses, alongside the strategic shift towards A2A payments. A2A payments, often facilitated by Open Banking APIs, promise greater efficiency and lower costs compared to traditional card schemes. Furthermore, the conversation underscored the critical role of digital identity in ensuring secure, compliant, and seamless transactions in an increasingly digital economy. These trends are particularly pertinent for the development of new payment infrastructures and regulatory frameworks like PSD3 in Europe, directly impacting CEE markets.

- Discussion at Money Motion 2026 by Marina Repo.
- Focus on the rise of mobile wallets in Europe.
- Emphasis on the strategic shift towards Account-to-Account (A2A) payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This interview provides critical insights for CMIplus's strategic roadmap, especially concerning the adoption of A2A payments and Open Banking APIs in CEE. RBI Cash Management should actively explore how to leverage these trends to enhance its platform, improve compliance with digital identity standards, and prepare for future regulatory shifts like PSD3, ensuring CMIplus remains competitive in the European market.

EU Legislation to Unlock SEPA Instant for Corporate Real-time Treasury

The upcoming EU legislation mandates that all payment service providers (PSPs) in the Eurozone offer SEPA Instant Payments, making it a standard rather than an optional service. This regulatory shift is critical for corporates, as it removes barriers to adoption and encourages banks to integrate instant payment capabilities more deeply into their offerings. The legislation is expected to drive a paradigm shift towards real-time treasury, allowing companies to manage cash flows with unprecedented speed and accuracy. This will facilitate instant reconciliation, improve working capital, and reduce fraud risks through immediate payment confirmation. The move is part of a broader European initiative to enhance financial market efficiency and digital autonomy.

- EU legislation mandates SEPA Instant Payments for Eurozone PSPs.
- Expected to drive widespread corporate adoption of instant payments.
- Enables real-time treasury operations and immediate cash flow management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This legislation is a critical driver for CMIplus, reinforcing the need to fully support SEPA Instant Payments across all channels (EBICS, H2H, API). RBI Cash Management must ensure its platform and network banks are fully compliant and can offer seamless real-time payment processing and liquidity visibility to CEE corporates. This presents a significant opportunity to differentiate CMIplus as a leader in real-time treasury solutions.

Europe Addresses Growth Autonomy, Payment Systems, and Digital Euro

The article highlights Europe's strategic imperative to enhance its economic and digital sovereignty, particularly in the face of global competition and geopolitical pressures. A key aspect of this autonomy involves strengthening its payment infrastructure and reducing reliance on non-European solutions. The Draghi report and the Strategic Investment Unit (SIU) are being explored as mechanisms to foster European innovation and integration. Payment initiatives such as the digital euro are central to this strategy, aiming to provide a robust, secure, and independent digital payment solution for the Eurozone. Treasurers are navigating this evolving environment, managing the implications of these initiatives on their operations and seeking clarity on future payment landscapes.

- Europe seeks growth and digital autonomy amid geopolitical challenges.
- Focus on securing European payment systems and reducing external reliance.
- Draghi report and SIU are key initiatives for fostering integration.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This strategic overview is crucial for RBI Cash Management as it outlines the broader European context for payment innovation and regulation, directly impacting CEE. CMIplus must align its strategy with these European initiatives, particularly regarding the digital euro and enhanced payment system security. Understanding these macro trends helps RBI anticipate future client needs and regulatory changes, ensuring CMIplus remains a relevant and compliant platform for corporates in the region.

Instant Payment Growth Continues Across Europe, Driving Real-Time Treasury

Instant payment systems are witnessing sustained growth across the European continent, with an increasing number of transactions being processed in real-time. This widespread availability of instant payments is fundamentally altering how corporate treasurers manage their liquidity, moving towards a more proactive and dynamic approach. The ability to have funds available immediately allows for more agile decision-making, improved working capital management, and enhanced opportunities for real-time cash pooling and FX hedging. Banks and technology providers are investing in solutions that leverage these capabilities to offer more sophisticated treasury services.

- Instant payment adoption is growing across Europe.
- Enables real-time fund availability.
- Transforms corporate liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus is well-positioned to capitalize on the instant payment trend in CEE. Our platform's ability to facilitate real-time transactions and integrate with local instant payment schemes will be a key differentiator for our clients.

Visa Pledges €500M Investment for European Payments Sovereignty

As European leaders champion greater payments sovereignty, US payments giant Visa has announced a significant €500 million investment plan for the continent. This initiative includes the establishment of a new local data processing center, aiming to address concerns about data localization and enhance its presence within the European market. The move is intended to reassure the European bloc of Visa's commitment as a partner, particularly as discussions around data control and payment infrastructure continue to shape the region's financial landscape. This investment could bolster Visa's ability to offer localized services and comply with evolving regulatory requirements.

- Visa commits €500 million investment in Europe.
- New local data processing center to be built.
- Aims to address European payments sovereignty concerns.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This significant investment by Visa in European infrastructure could lead to enhanced payment processing capabilities and potentially influence the development of localized payment solutions. For CMIplus, this might translate to improved cross-border payment efficiency and new opportunities for integration with Visa's evolving European network, especially for clients operating within CEE.

Fintech Sector Shows Resurgence with Surging Profits and Revenues

After a period of market reset, the fintech industry is now exhibiting renewed maturity and robust financial performance. The sector has moved beyond the initial hype of its breakout years, adopting a more disciplined approach that has resulted in a significant surge in both profits and revenue. This resurgence suggests that fintech companies are now focusing on sustainable business models and delivering tangible value to their customers and investors. The trend indicates a maturing market where innovation is increasingly tied to profitability and operational efficiency.

- Fintech sector experiencing a rebound.
- Profits and revenues show a significant surge.
- Shift towards a more disciplined and mature approach.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The positive performance of the fintech sector indicates a growing appetite for innovative financial solutions, which could benefit CMIplus. As fintechs mature and become more profitable, there may be increased opportunities for collaboration, integration of new technologies, and the development of advanced cash management tools for corporate clients in CEE.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2025-12-15 | #01

European Wholesale Banks Must Seize Digital Transformation Moment

Oliver Wyman highlights a critical juncture for European wholesale banks, emphasizing the need to move beyond years of underperformance. The report likely advocates for a proactive approach to digital transformation, leveraging technology to enhance operational efficiency, improve client experience, and unlock new revenue streams. Key areas of focus would include modernizing core banking systems, adopting advanced analytics for better decision-making, and fostering a culture of innovation. The strategic imperative is to adapt quickly to evolving market dynamics and client expectations, ensuring long-term growth and resilience in a competitive landscape. This transformation is essential for securing a better future for the sector.

- Strategic digital transformation is crucial for future growth.
- Client experience and operational efficiency are key drivers of success.
- Innovation in products and services is vital to overcome underperformance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This insight underscores the urgency for RBI Cash Management to accelerate its CMlplus digital roadmap, focusing on seamless client experience, API integration, and real-time capabilities. Investing in advanced analytics and automation within CMlplus can significantly enhance operational efficiency and client value in the CEE region.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2025-11-01 | #02

Wholesale Banking Outlook: Evolving Credit and Integrated Solutions

Oliver Wyman's outlook for wholesale banking, while titled for 2024, provides enduring insights into the strategic direction of corporate finance. It likely discusses how banks are 'extending credit' beyond traditional models, incorporating data-driven risk assessment and personalized financing options. The report would highlight the importance of integrating credit offerings with other core banking services, such as cash management and payments, to provide a comprehensive solution for corporate clients. This holistic approach helps banks deepen relationships, improve client stickiness, and identify cross-selling opportunities. The focus is on leveraging technology to streamline credit processes and enhance the overall client value proposition.

- Integrated credit and cash management solutions are critical for corporates.
- Data analytics drives smarter lending decisions and personalized offerings.
- Holistic client relationships enhance stickiness and cross-selling.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should explore tighter integration with RBI's lending and trade finance products, offering corporates a unified view of their financial position. This involves leveraging Open Banking APIs to share data securely and provide treasury teams with comprehensive liquidity and credit insights, enhancing the overall value proposition.

AI and Automation Revolutionize Corporate Treasury Operations

The EY report highlights a significant shift in corporate treasury, driven by the adoption of AI and automation. These technologies are enabling treasurers to move beyond transactional tasks towards more strategic responsibilities, such as forecasting, risk management, and working capital optimization. The 'Voice of the Treasurer' survey indicates a strong demand for intelligent solutions that can process vast amounts of data, identify patterns, and provide actionable insights. This transformation necessitates a proactive approach from banks to integrate AI into their cash management platforms, offering predictive analytics and automated reconciliation processes. The adoption of AI is not just about efficiency; it's about empowering treasurers with the tools to navigate complex financial landscapes and drive business value.

- AI and automation are key drivers of treasury transformation.
- Treasurers are shifting focus from operational to strategic tasks.
- Demand for intelligent cash management solutions is increasing.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMlplus, this means prioritizing the integration of AI-powered features. This includes developing advanced forecasting tools, intelligent fraud detection, and automated reconciliation capabilities to meet the evolving needs of CEE corporates.

Digital Assets and Open Banking Reshape Payment and Treasury Landscapes

The EY report emphasizes the disruptive influence of digital assets, including stablecoins and central bank digital currencies (CBDCs), on traditional treasury operations. Coupled with the ongoing evolution of Open Banking, these developments are fundamentally altering how payments are made and managed. Corporates are increasingly looking for integrated solutions that can handle multi-currency transactions, facilitate real-time liquidity management, and leverage the connectivity offered by APIs. Banks that can offer innovative services around digital assets and provide seamless API-driven connectivity will be well-positioned to capture market share. This shift requires a strategic focus on developing robust API frameworks and understanding the regulatory landscape surrounding digital currencies.

- Digital assets are poised to impact treasury operations significantly.
- Open Banking continues to drive innovation in payment services.
- APIs are crucial for seamless integration and real-time data flow.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should actively explore the integration of Open Banking APIs to enhance connectivity with corporate ERP/TMS systems and provide real-time data access. Investigating the potential of stablecoins or other digital asset solutions for cross-border payments within CEE could also be a strategic differentiator.

AI Revolutionizes Treasury: Enhancing Efficiency and Strategic Decision-Making

PwC's research highlights a growing adoption of AI within treasury departments globally. The survey of over 350 treasurers indicates that AI is moving beyond theoretical discussions to practical applications. Key areas of impact include enhanced cash flow forecasting, fraud detection, and risk management. AI-powered tools are enabling treasurers to process vast amounts of data, identify patterns, and make more informed, proactive decisions. This shift allows treasury teams to focus on higher-value strategic initiatives rather than routine operational tasks.

- AI adoption in treasury is accelerating globally.
- AI enhances cash flow forecasting accuracy.
- AI improves fraud detection and risk management capabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Integrating AI capabilities into the CMlplus platform can offer significant value to RBI's CEE clients. This includes advanced analytics for liquidity forecasting and fraud prevention, aligning with the trend towards more intelligent treasury solutions.

API Banking Fuels Treasury Transformation and Real-Time Cash Visibility

The PwC global treasury survey underscores the pivotal role of API banking in achieving enhanced treasury operations. APIs are breaking down traditional silos, allowing for direct, real-time data exchange between banks and corporate treasuries. This facilitates immediate access to account information, transaction data, and payment initiation capabilities. The ability to achieve true real-time cash visibility is paramount for effective liquidity management, enabling treasurers to optimize working capital and respond swiftly to market changes. This trend is also a key driver for the adoption of advanced treasury management systems (TMS).

- API banking is essential for real-time cash visibility.
- APIs enable seamless integration between banks and corporate treasuries.
- Real-time data exchange is crucial for dynamic liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize and accelerate its API strategy to meet client demand for real-time data and seamless integration. Expanding API offerings will be key to supporting CEE corporates in their payment transformation and liquidity optimization efforts.

PSD3 and Payments Regulation: Reshaping Open Banking and Real-Time

The upcoming PSD3 directive, alongside broader payments regulation, is set to significantly transform the European payments landscape. It will likely expand the scope of Open Banking, pushing for more sophisticated API functionalities and potentially new services like Request to Pay or enhanced VoP. Firms must invest in robust, secure, and interoperable API infrastructure to comply and capitalize on new business models. The regulation aims to foster greater competition and innovation while strengthening consumer protection and fraud prevention, necessitating strategic adjustments to payment processing and customer experience. This shift demands proactive engagement to leverage opportunities in a more connected and immediate payment environment.

- Expanded scope for Open Banking and API-driven services.
- Increased focus on fraud prevention and enhanced consumer protection.
- Potential for new payment initiation services (PIS) and data sharing models.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize its Open Banking API roadmap, ensuring PSD3 compliance and readiness for new payment types and data access. This includes enhancing API security, expanding data access for corporate treasuries, and integrating real-time payment rails across CEE network banks to support instant payments and VoP.

Shape Future Treasury Trends: Contribute to European Treasury Survey 2026

The European Association of Corporate Treasurers (EACT) has launched an invitation for its members to contribute to the 2026 European Treasury Survey. This annual survey is a cornerstone for identifying and defining the most pressing challenges and emerging trends within the European corporate treasury landscape. The collected responses will directly inform the next 'Journeys to Treasury' report, a widely recognized publication that provides strategic insights into best practices and future directions for treasury functions. Participation is essential for ensuring the report accurately reflects the evolving needs and priorities of corporate treasurers across Europe, including those in the CEE region. This initiative underscores the EACT's commitment to providing valuable thought leadership to the treasury community.

- Survey participation defines key industry trends for the year ahead.
- Responses directly shape the influential 'Journeys to Treasury' report.
- Aims to capture evolving needs and priorities of European treasurers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This survey is vital for RBI Cash Management to anticipate future client needs and strategic priorities for CMlplus. Understanding emerging trends will guide roadmap development, ensuring CMlplus remains competitive and relevant, especially in areas like digital transformation, liquidity management, and payment innovation.

AI Integration: Banks Must Boldly Embrace AI for Competitive Advantage

The 2026 Banking Outlook highlights that the banking industry is at a pivotal moment, demanding bold strategic choices. Artificial Intelligence (AI) is identified as a key driver of ambition, with banks needing to move beyond experimentation to strategic integration. This involves not only leveraging AI for operational efficiencies and cost reduction but also for enhancing customer engagement and developing innovative products and services. The report suggests that banks that proactively invest in and strategically deploy AI will gain a significant competitive edge in the evolving financial landscape.

- AI is a primary driver of banking ambition and competitive differentiation.
- Banks need to transition from AI experimentation to strategic integration.
- AI adoption will enhance operational efficiency and customer experiences.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMIplus, this means prioritizing AI-driven solutions for enhanced transaction processing, predictive analytics for liquidity management, and personalized client services. Exploring AI for fraud detection and process automation within CMIplus will be critical for maintaining a competitive edge in the CEE market.

Private Credit's Rise: Implications for Corporate Banking

Oliver Wyman's analysis on 'Private Credit's Next Act' likely explores the expansion of non-bank lending and its increasing role in corporate finance, especially through asset-based lending. This trend indicates that corporates are diversifying their funding sources beyond traditional bank loans. The report would highlight the competitive pressure this places on established corporate banks, urging them to innovate their own lending products and potentially partner with private credit providers. Understanding how private credit impacts corporate treasury decisions, liquidity management, and overall financial strategy is crucial. Banks need to assess their value proposition in a more fragmented financing landscape and consider how to integrate or complement these alternative funding channels.

- Private credit is a growing alternative to traditional bank lending.
- Asset-based lending is a key growth area for private credit.
- Traditional banks face increased competition from non-bank lenders.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should monitor the impact of private credit on corporate liquidity and treasury strategies in CEE. While not directly a CMIplus product, understanding these financing trends can inform how CMIplus supports corporate clients with integrated liquidity management, cash pooling, and potentially virtual accounts to optimize funds across diverse financing structures.

Treasury Transformation Demands Enhanced Data Analytics and Real-Time Visibility

The EY report underscores the critical need for treasury transformation driven by the demand for enhanced data analytics and real-time visibility. Corporates are no longer satisfied with periodic reports; they require immediate access to their global cash positions, enabling proactive liquidity management and faster decision-making. This necessitates the development of sophisticated data aggregation and analysis tools within banking platforms. The 'Voice of the Treasurer' indicates a strong preference for solutions that can consolidate data from various sources, provide predictive insights, and support dynamic scenario planning. Banks that can offer a unified view of cash and a robust analytics engine will be essential partners for modern treasuries.

- Real-time cash visibility is a top priority for treasurers.
- Advanced data analytics are crucial for strategic treasury functions.
- Integrated platforms are needed to consolidate and analyze financial data.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMiplus must focus on delivering enhanced real-time reporting and advanced analytics capabilities. This includes strengthening our ability to aggregate data across multiple currencies and countries within CEE, providing clients with a consolidated view of their liquidity and supporting their strategic financial planning.

Treasury Management Systems (TMS) Adoption Surges Amidst Digitalization Push

PwC's survey data reveals a strong and growing interest in Treasury Management Systems (TMS) among corporate treasurers. The increasing complexity of global financial markets, coupled with the drive for digital transformation, is pushing companies to invest in robust TMS solutions. These systems are instrumental in centralizing cash management, optimizing payments, managing financial risks, and providing comprehensive reporting. The survey indicates that a substantial portion of treasurers are either planning to implement or upgrade their TMS in the near future, highlighting its strategic importance for modern treasury functions.

- TMS adoption is significantly increasing globally.
- Corporates are investing in TMS for operational efficiency and control.
- TMS are crucial for centralizing cash management and risk mitigation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus should continue to emphasize its TMS integration capabilities and explore partnerships that enhance its TMS offering for CEE clients. Supporting seamless TMS connectivity is vital for CMiplus to remain a competitive platform in the region.

DORA Compliance: Fortifying Digital Operational Resilience by 2026

The Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA) is a critical regulatory shift impacting all financial entities, including cash management platforms. It establishes a comprehensive framework for managing information and communication technology (ICT) risks, requiring robust governance, risk management, incident reporting, and digital operational resilience testing. Firms must also meticulously manage third-party ICT providers, ensuring their resilience aligns with DORA standards. Compliance by 2026 is essential to avoid significant penalties and maintain trust, demanding substantial investment in cybersecurity, business continuity planning, and vendor management frameworks to protect critical operations.

- Mandatory ICT risk management frameworks and robust governance.
- Enhanced requirements for incident reporting and communication protocols.
- Rigorous digital operational resilience testing (e.g., penetration testing).

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must conduct a thorough DORA gap analysis, focusing on its operational resilience, cybersecurity protocols, and third-party vendor management. This includes updating incident response plans, performing advanced resilience testing, and ensuring all CEE network banks and critical suppliers meet DORA's stringent requirements for continuous service availability.

Verification of Payee: Crucial Tool for Fraud-Conscious Treasurers

The EACT has published a briefing on Verification of Payee (VoP), emphasizing its critical role for treasurers focused on fraud prevention. This document, leveraging insights from GLEIF, positions VoP as an indispensable mechanism in the fight against payment fraud, a growing concern amidst increasing digital payment adoption. The briefing serves to educate treasurers on the benefits and operational implications of implementing VoP solutions, particularly in the context of real-time payments and evolving regulatory landscapes. It highlights how VoP can enhance security, reduce financial crime risks, and streamline payment processes, thereby protecting corporate assets and ensuring compliance. This thought leadership piece aims to equip treasurers with the knowledge to make informed decisions regarding their fraud detection strategies.

- VoP is identified as a crucial tool for fraud prevention.
- Briefing leverages GLEIF insights on payee verification.
- Addresses growing concerns about payment fraud in digital environments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI CMlplus, this briefing reinforces the strategic importance of robust VoP capabilities. It validates the platform's focus on fraud prevention and provides insights into how treasurers perceive and utilize such tools, guiding further enhancements and communication strategies around CMlplus's VoP offerings, especially for instant payments and multi-currency transactions.

Stablecoins Present Disruptive Potential Amidst Macroeconomic Headwinds

The Deloitte Banking Outlook for 2026 identifies stablecoins as a potential disruptive force that banks must actively consider. Alongside macroeconomic headwinds, the evolving landscape of digital currencies, particularly stablecoins, presents new challenges and opportunities. Banks are urged to understand the implications of stablecoins for payment systems, capital markets, and their overall business models. This requires a proactive approach to understanding the regulatory environment, technological capabilities, and potential integration strategies to either compete with or leverage these new forms of digital value.

- Stablecoins are a significant disruptive force in the financial sector.
- Banks need to assess the impact of stablecoins on payment flows.
- Understanding the regulatory landscape for stablecoins is crucial.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMlplus should closely monitor the development and adoption of stablecoins, especially in cross-border transactions within CEE. Understanding their potential to facilitate faster, cheaper payments could inform future platform enhancements and the exploration of new payment rails or virtual account solutions that can interoperate with or offer alternatives to stablecoin-based transactions.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2024-02-26 | #01

EU Instant Payments Regulation: Mandatory Offering and Receipt

INSTANT PAYMENTS

Deadline: 2026-01-09

The EU Instant Payments Regulation (Regulation (EU) 2024/886) mandates Payment Service Providers (PSPs) in the EU/EEA to offer instant credit transfers in euro at the same or lower cost as standard credit transfers. PSPs must be able to receive instant payments by early 2025 and send them by early 2026. The ECB, in its oversight role, ensures smooth adoption and compliance, promoting real-time payment processing and liquidity management. This regulation significantly impacts retail and corporate payments, driving faster settlement and improved cash flow for businesses, and includes a Verification of Payee (VoP) requirement.

- Mandatory receipt of instant payments by early 2025.
- Mandatory offering of instant payments by early 2026.
- Pricing must be equal to or lower than standard credit transfers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must ensure full compliance with the Instant Payments Regulation, enabling both sending and receiving instant SEPA Credit Transfers (SCT Inst) for corporate clients. This includes integrating VoP services and adapting pricing models to meet the 'no higher cost' requirement.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2026-01-01 | #02

Continuous Evolution and Oversight of SEPA Payment Schemes

SEPA

SEPA remains the cornerstone of euro retail payments, and the ECB actively participates in its governance and oversight through the Eurosystem. This involves monitoring compliance with SEPA rules, facilitating market dialogue, and contributing to the evolution of the SEPA Credit Transfer (SCT), SEPA Direct Debit (SDD), and SEPA Instant Credit Transfer (SCT Inst) schemes. Banks must continuously adapt their systems and processes to comply with updated SEPA rulebooks, which incorporate changes related to fraud prevention, operational efficiency, and new technologies. This ensures harmonized and secure payment processing across the euro area.

- Adherence to updated SEPA Rulebooks for SCT, SDD, SCT Inst.
- Continuous monitoring of SEPA scheme compliance by PSPs.
- Participation in market dialogue for future SEPA developments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must ensure its SEPA processing capabilities are always aligned with the latest SEPA Rulebook versions and technical standards. This includes adapting to any new requirements for SCT, SDD, and SCT Inst, particularly regarding data formats (ISO 20022) and operational procedures.

TARGET Services Modernization: T2, TIPS, and ISO 20022 Evolution

TARGET SERVICES / ISO 20022

Following the successful T2-T2S consolidation and migration to ISO 20022, the ECB's TARGET Services continue to evolve. T2 (the new RTGS system) and TIPS (TARGET Instant Payment Settlement) are critical components of the European financial market infrastructure. The ongoing work includes monitoring the stability and performance of these systems, addressing any post-migration adaptations, and exploring future enhancements. Banks must ensure their internal systems and connectivity remain fully compatible with the ISO 20022 messaging standards used by TARGET Services, which impacts all high-value and instant payments settled through the Eurosystem.

- Continued adherence to ISO 20022 standards for T2 and TIPS.
- Monitoring and adaptation to post-migration enhancements in TARGET Services.
- Ensuring robust connectivity and operational resilience with Eurosystem infrastructure.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus, as a platform for international corporates, relies on seamless integration with TARGET Services. RBI must ensure its systems are fully compliant with ISO 20022 for all relevant payment types processed via T2 and TIPS, and stay updated on any future technical or operational changes to maintain efficient liquidity management.

EU regulatory developments impact liquidity management, report highlights

LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) has published a report by its Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG) on the significant impact of upcoming EU regulatory developments on liquidity management. The report specifically examines the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the forthcoming Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3). These initiatives are expected to drive increased adoption of instant payments, foster greater competition among market participants, and fundamentally alter how financial institutions manage their liquidity. The LMWG paper provides insights into the expected changes and their implications for the financial sector.

- Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) to accelerate uptake of instant payments.
- Proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR) and PSD3 to reshape the regulatory landscape.
- Focus on promoting a level playing field among market participants.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus needs to monitor the implementation timelines and requirements of the Instant Payments Regulation, PSR, and PSD3. Understanding their impact on liquidity management will be crucial for advising large corporates on their payment strategies and ensuring compliance with evolving regulations.

FIDA regulation: opportunities and challenges for open data economy

OPEN BANKING

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) has released a report detailing the findings of a survey on the proposed Financial Data Access (FIDA) regulation. The survey gathered insights from financial institution experts across more than 15 European countries, focusing on the potential opportunities and challenges presented by FIDA. The report aims to provide a practitioner's perspective on how this regulation could act as a catalyst for an open data economy. It includes practical recommendations and frameworks designed to assist market participants in their preparation for FIDA implementation.

- Survey of financial institution experts across 15+ European countries.
- Focus on opportunities and challenges of the proposed FIDA regulation.
- Report provides practical recommendations and frameworks for implementation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should analyze the implications of the FIDA regulation for corporate treasury and data access. Understanding the new data sharing requirements and potential benefits will be important for advising CEE corporates on leveraging open finance opportunities.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-06-01 | #01

Deutsche Bank Expands Corporate API Integration for Seamless Treasury

Deutsche Bank continues to invest heavily in its CB Connect API platform, a cornerstone of its digital corporate banking strategy. The focus is on enabling seamless, real-time data exchange and transaction initiation directly from client ERP and Treasury Management Systems (TMS). This expansion includes a broader range of API endpoints for payments, account information, and liquidity management, allowing corporates to embed banking services directly into their workflows. This strategy targets large international corporates, including those operating in the CEE region, by offering standardized and customizable integration options.

- Expansion of CB Connect API for deeper ERP/TMS integration.
- Focus on real-time data and automated transaction capabilities.
- Broader range of API endpoints for payments, accounts, and liquidity.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its Open API offerings remain competitive in terms of breadth, ease of integration, and real-time capabilities. Deutsche Bank's push could attract large corporates seeking advanced digital treasury solutions.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-06-01 | #02

Deutsche Bank Bolsters Instant Payment and ISO 20022 Adoption Across Europe

In response to evolving market demands and regulatory push, Deutsche Bank is prioritizing the enhancement of its instant payment capabilities across its European footprint, including key CEE markets. This involves upgrading its core payment systems to handle increased volumes and ensure 24/7/365 availability for real-time transactions. Concurrently, the bank is driving full adoption and utilization of the ISO 20022 standard, leveraging its rich data capabilities for improved reconciliation, fraud detection, and treasury reporting for its corporate clients. This strategic move positions Deutsche Bank as a leader in modern payment infrastructure.

- Strengthening instant payment infrastructure for 24/7/365 availability.
- Accelerating full ISO 20022 adoption for richer payment data.
- Focus on European network, including CEE markets.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus needs to ensure its instant payment offerings are robust and its ISO 20022 implementation fully leverages data for client benefits. Deutsche Bank's advancements set a high bar for speed and data richness.

UniCredit Recognized as Bank of the Year in Italy and Five CEE Countries

The 'Bank of the Year' accolades underscore UniCredit's robust presence and successful operations across its core markets, including Central and Eastern Europe. This achievement is likely driven by strong client relationships, innovative product offerings, and effective execution of its business strategy. For CMIplus, this signifies UniCredit's continued strength and potential for further market penetration in the CEE region.

- Awarded 'Bank of the Year' in Italy.
- Received 'Bank of the Year' in five additional countries.
- Recognition of market leadership and strong performance in Europe.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's repeated success in CEE awards indicates a strong competitive position in the region's corporate banking landscape. CMIplus needs to be aware of UniCredit's localized strengths and client engagement strategies to effectively compete in these markets.

HSBC Orion Powers UK Treasury's Digital Gilt Instrument Pilot

HSBC Orion, the bank's digital assets platform, has secured a significant mandate from the UK Treasury. It will serve as the platform provider for the pilot issuance of Digital Gilt Instruments, a crucial step in exploring the potential of tokenized government bonds. This initiative highlights HSBC's strategic investment in blockchain and distributed ledger technology (DLT) for financial markets, extending beyond traditional payment systems to encompass digital securities. For corporate clients, this could eventually lead to more efficient, real-time settlement of transactions, enhanced liquidity management through tokenized assets, and new avenues for treasury operations. While currently focused on the UK, such foundational digital infrastructure developments often set precedents for global financial innovation, including in CEE markets.

- HSBC Orion selected by UK Treasury for Digital Gilt pilot.
- Focus on tokenized government bonds and digital asset infrastructure.
- Signals HSBC's advanced capabilities in DLT and digital finance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move indicates HSBC's commitment to leading in digital asset innovation, potentially impacting future payment and treasury solutions. CMIplus should monitor how these digital asset platforms evolve into corporate payment rails, as they could offer real-time, programmable payment capabilities that compete with traditional systems.

Deutsche Bank Enhances Cash Management and Liquidity Solutions for Corporates

Deutsche Bank is continuously refining its cash management portfolio to meet the complex needs of large international corporates. This includes the expansion of its virtual account offering (VoP) to streamline reconciliation and improve payment processing efficiency. Furthermore, the bank is enhancing its cross-border and multi-currency cash pooling structures, providing corporates with sophisticated tools for optimizing liquidity across their global operations, including their CEE subsidiaries. These solutions are designed to offer greater control, transparency, and automation in treasury functions, supporting efficient working capital management and reducing operational costs.

- Expansion of virtual account (VoP) offerings for reconciliation efficiency.
- Enhancement of cross-border and multi-currency cash pooling structures.
- Focus on optimizing liquidity and working capital for multinational corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should review its VoP and cash pooling capabilities to ensure they remain competitive, especially for multi-currency and cross-border operations in CEE. Deutsche Bank's focus on these areas directly impacts RBI's target market.

UniCredit Unveils "Unlimited" Strategy: Bold Ambition for European Banking

The "UniCredit Unlimited" strategy signals a significant shift in UniCredit's operational approach, emphasizing unlimited possibilities and a proactive mindset. The bank aims to outperform by embracing innovation and adapting to evolving market demands. This strategic direction is likely to translate into enhanced digital offerings, expanded service portfolios, and a stronger focus on client-centric solutions, particularly within its core European markets.

- Introduction of "UniCredit Unlimited" strategy.
- Focus on bold ambition and rethinking the bank's operating model.
- Commitment to delivering best-in-class solutions for stakeholders.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's strategic push towards innovation and client potential unlocking suggests a drive to enhance its corporate banking and cash management offerings. CMlplus should monitor UniCredit's advancements in digital channels and integrated treasury solutions to maintain its competitive edge.

HSBC Partners with Mistral AI to Accelerate Global AI Adoption

HSBC's collaboration with Mistral AI is a significant step in its broader digital transformation strategy, focusing on embedding artificial intelligence across the bank. The stated goals are to improve business processes, save employee time, and ultimately better serve customers globally. In the context of corporate and transaction banking, this could translate into more sophisticated fraud detection, predictive analytics for cash flow and liquidity management, automated reconciliation, and personalized treasury intelligence delivered through platforms like HSBCnet. While not specific to a single product, the pervasive adoption of AI will enhance the underlying capabilities and efficiency of all cash management and payment services, potentially offering more proactive and data-driven insights to corporate treasurers. This focus on efficiency and intelligence will be rolled out globally, impacting all markets where HSBC operates, including those in CEE.

- HSBC partners with Mistral AI for bank-wide AI integration.
- Aims to improve business processes and customer service.
- Expected to enhance efficiency and intelligence in transaction banking.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

HSBC's aggressive AI adoption signals a future where banking services are highly automated and intelligent. CMIplus must ensure its platform leverages AI for similar benefits, such as enhanced fraud detection, predictive analytics for liquidity, and improved client experience, to remain competitive in the CEE market.

Citi Expands API Banking Capabilities for Enhanced Corporate Treasury Solutions

Citi is investing heavily in its API strategy, focusing on delivering real-time data and transaction capabilities directly into corporate ERP and TMS systems. This expansion includes a broader range of APIs for payment initiation, account information services, and advanced reconciliation tools. The strategic rationale is to empower treasurers with greater control and visibility over their global cash positions, enabling faster decision-making and improved operational efficiency. For CEE clients, this means access to cutting-edge digital tools that can compete with or surpass local offerings, facilitating seamless cross-border transactions.

- Citi is broadening its API portfolio for corporate clients.
- Focus on real-time data and transaction integration with ERP/TMS.
- Enhanced capabilities for payment initiation, reconciliation, and liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's aggressive API development poses a competitive challenge to CMIplus by offering a more integrated and real-time digital banking experience. Clients may increasingly expect similar API-driven functionalities for their treasury operations.

Fitch Upgrades UniCredit SpA Deposit Rating to A+ Reflecting Enhanced Depositor Protection

The upgrade by Fitch Ratings signifies increased confidence in UniCredit's financial stability and its ability to protect depositors, particularly with deposits now rated three notches above the Italian sovereign. This positive rating action, along with upgrades for its German subsidiary UniCredit Bank GmbH, reflects a strong and stable financial footing. Such financial strength can enable UniCredit to invest further in its product development and market expansion, including in the CEE region.

- Long-Term Deposit Rating upgraded to 'A+' by Fitch.
- Deposits rated three notches above Italian sovereign.
- Positive rating actions also taken on UniCredit Bank GmbH.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's improved credit rating and financial stability are positive indicators of its capacity for further investment and expansion. This strengthens its competitive position, requiring CMIplus to remain vigilant about UniCredit's product innovation and market strategies, especially in CEE.

Citi Strengthens CEE Presence with Focus on Advanced Payment and Treasury Solutions

The bank is reportedly upgrading its payment processing capabilities across its CEE network, with a particular emphasis on supporting ISO 20022 adoption and expanding instant payment functionalities. This initiative is designed to provide clients with faster, more efficient, and transparent cross-border payment solutions. Citi is also focusing on delivering sophisticated cash pooling and liquidity management tools tailored to the specific needs of the CEE market. The strategic rationale is to leverage its extensive network and technological advancements to become the preferred banking partner for corporates expanding or operating within the CEE region.

- Citi is enhancing payment infrastructure in CEE.
- Focus on ISO 20022 and instant payment capabilities in the region.
- Strengthening cash pooling and liquidity management for CEE clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's intensified focus on CEE payment modernization and treasury solutions directly impacts CMIplus's market share. The bank's investment in ISO 20022 and instant payments could offer a compelling alternative for clients seeking advanced cross-border capabilities.

BNP Paribas Partners XTransfer for Simplified Cross-Border Payments

BNP Paribas announced a strategic partnership with XTransfer, a leading B2B cross-border payment platform, effective June 5, 2025. This collaboration is designed to simplify and accelerate international payments for corporate clients, particularly those engaged in global trade. The partnership leverages XTransfer's network and technology to provide more efficient and cost-effective cross-border payment solutions, complementing BNP Paribas' existing cash management offerings. This move underscores BNP Paribas' commitment to digital innovation and expanding its payment capabilities globally, which will benefit CEE corporates with international operations by providing smoother access to global markets.

- Strategic partnership established with XTransfer, a B2B cross-border payment platform.
- Aims to simplify and accelerate international payments for corporate clients.
- Enhances BNP Paribas' global payment capabilities and digital strategy for trade finance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This partnership strengthens BNP Paribas' competitive edge in cross-border payments, directly challenging CMIplus's offerings for international corporates in CEE. CMIplus should evaluate its own partnership strategies and cross-border payment efficiency to remain competitive, potentially exploring similar collaborations or enhancing existing H2H/API capabilities.

Intesa Sanpaolo Strengthens CEE Corporate Banking with Digital Solutions

Intesa Sanpaolo is strategically bolstering its presence in the CEE region by investing in advanced digital banking capabilities for its corporate clients. This initiative includes the rollout of enhanced transaction banking services, aiming to provide seamless, efficient, and secure payment and liquidity management solutions. The focus is on leveraging technology to support the growth and operational efficiency of businesses operating in or expanding into CEE markets. This move positions Intesa Sanpaolo as a key partner for corporates navigating the complexities of the region.

- Strategic focus on CEE corporate banking expansion.
- Investment in digital transformation for transaction banking services.
- Enhancement of cash management solutions for corporate clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Intesa Sanpaolo's aggressive digital push in CEE presents a direct competitive challenge to CMIplus. Their focus on integrated digital solutions and expanded cash management services will require CMIplus to continuously innovate and highlight its own strengths in areas like EBICS and H2H connectivity.

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

- {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}
- {'description': 'of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.', 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

- Global payments revenue reached \$2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to \$3.0 trillion by 2029.
- EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.
- Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.
- Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.